

THE CITIZEN RETURNS

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A Half Life 2 Ep2 Single Player Modification

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Installation Instructions

0. Make sure you have the pertinent Steam software installed for running Ep2 mods.
1. Close down Steam, if it is running.
2. Copy the whole "The Citizen Returns" folder into your *sourcemods* folder. Your *sourcemods* folder is inside your Steam directory. By default, the path will be:
C:\Program Files\Valve\Steam\steamapps\sourcemods
3. Start up Steam. "The Citizen Returns" should appear on your installed games menu.

Subtitle instructions

Enable subtitles in the Options>Audio menu. If they are not being displayed in your language (if available), you can use a console command to force the engine to display a particular language.

That would be: *cc_lang english* , *cc_lang german*, *cc_lang french* or *cc_lang spanish*.

Introduction

Set in both the heart and outside of City 17, "The Citizen Returns" contains the final chapters of our citizen's story, as well as an updated version of Part II.

The story takes place shortly after a failed assassination attempt on Dr. Breen leads to the first ever use of the Overwatch Broadcast system by The Resistance, represented by former garage owner Larry Soderstrom Jr.

The Combine forces decide to capture him and try to use his public repentance and execution as a means to appease the emergent rebellion.

The Citizens of City 17 however have other ideas in mind. Larry is now a symbol for the rebellion and a key asset in a bigger plot to deal a fatal blow to the Combine and its grip on humankind...

Easter Eggs

The first 16 maps contain a few notes or letters that trigger a little scene in the 17th map if you find them all. Due to technical issues we were unable to fix, you must use the USE button to read them, and the USE button again to stop reading. **It's important that you are facing the note or letter in question for this to work, as it works like a regular button.**

Content

All content in The Citizen Returns is either original Half Life 2 content (both modified and unmodified), or is custom content and derivative work created and/or performed entirely by the below.

- Custom Textures (including modified HL2 textures) by:

Jose Ameyugo
Chris Fox
Amanda Horan
Dennis Glowacki

- Custom Models by:

Jose Ameyugo
Amanda Horan
Dennis Glowacki

- Voice Acting by:

Anne Fox
Jason Fielding
Chris Fox
David Maylia
Cayetana Ameyugo
Jose Ameyugo
Eric Soderstrom Jr.
Mike Hillard
Tony Newton
Phillip Marlowe
James Archibald
Andy Morris
William McMahon

- Custom Music by:

Kevin McLeod <http://incompetech.com/music/>

Performance

We have tried to optimize this mod as much as possible, using VIS-blocking techniques, prop fade distance, occluders and areaportals. However, there was a significant downgrade in the Source Engine since the release of Part II which causes some visual problems. We have done our best to minimize them, but fixing them completely would require redoing some of the map layouts from scratch.

-Several "too many vertex format changes in frame..." will appear in the game console at times.

-Disappearing brushes in sp_streetwar and sp_presquare.

-Some reflective textures like windows having no specularity at all. Most notably in sp_square (this was a needed adjustment to alleviate the problems mentioned above).

General performance for the mod meets the requirements that HL2 Ep2 itself has. Some low frame rates on low-end systems can take place in sp_square, but most systems will have no trouble with the mod at all.

Playtesting

Play-throughs and reviews of The Citizen Part II over the past three years were useful to improve the mod, but this time we also had a lot of serious testing done, including the input from the Beta Testers Collective. <http://betatesterscollective.com/>

Why was the mod delayed for so long?

Engine updates that broke the mod several times, lack of motivation and big changes in our lives are probably to blame. Also, we admit this mod was overly ambitious and we ended up depending on a lot of factors (and people) to put it all together. The basic story and the 17 maps themselves already existed by the end of 2008 in some form or another. When we released "The Citizen Part II" in 2010, this is what the mod was supposed to be like, plus a few more choices and multiple endings that we had to cut out. There was never a separate "Part III" mod, so to speak.

Distribution

As a free HL2 mod, "The Citizen Returns" may be re-distributed freely to other HL2 owners, as long as it remains in unmodified form. Please do not use the custom content of The Citizen Returns for your own work without contacting us first. We will most likely say yes to requests to use anything, but we'd like you to contact us at the email addresses at the end of this document before doing so.

Thanks.

Comments?

Rate & leave a comment on our Moddb page for the mod or PlanetPhillip!

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